

Velos Logistics — Speaker Scripts

10-minute case defense · Technology & Digital Business · Prof. Marc Sansó · April 2026

Presenter assignment

Presenter A opens (Slide 1) and delivers the diagnosis (Slide 2). **Presenter B** delivers the recommendation (Slide 3) and fields the first Q&A. Either presenter can take questions inside their own area.

Slide 1 — Title

Presenter A · ~30 seconds

“Good morning. Our argument is that the Velos board is being offered a false binary — Retrench or Double Down — and that both are losing moves. We will recommend a third path: a Consortium Pivot that converts Velos’s competitors into co-founders of an industry standard. We’ll diagnose why the platform is stalled in two minutes, then walk through the three moves that get Velos across the Disruption Gate.”

Slide 2 — Diagnosis

Presenter A · ~4 minutes

“First, the structural diagnosis.

Velos operates two completely opposed business models on one balance sheet. Prime is a Model 1.0 freight business — heavily variable cost structure, 10% gross margin, scaling linearly with fuel and headcount. Trust attempts Model 2.0 — heavily fixed cost structure, 83% gross margin, exponential operating leverage past breakeven. These are not two divisions of one company. They are two different companies that share a balance sheet.

Now apply the Inevitability Cascade. Trust has cleared three of the four phases. Phase 1, Tech Functionality — DLT works, smart contracts execute reliably. Phase 2, Hard Use Cases — the 20% administrative cost reduction is real, measurable, and repeatable. Phase 3, Business Model — the 83% gross margin proves the unit economics work in principle. But Phase 4, Dominant Ecosystem, is missing entirely. No standards. No orchestrator. No network self-propulsion.

Phase 4 is the Disruption Gate. It is the only phase where structural disruption actually happens. Without crossing it, the first three phases are stranded investments. Velos has built the engine. The road network does not exist yet.

Apply the Triple Crown lens and the picture sharpens. Native Interface — yes. Dominant Business Model logic — yes. Dominant Ecosystem — no. That is why the CTO’s ‘Trough of Disillusionment’ is not a tech failure. It is a kinetic asymmetry: Layer 1 raced ahead while Layer 4 hasn’t started. Banks, customs authorities, ERP vendors, and competitors are the rate limit — not the technology.

There is a deeper structural read here, and it is the one our team converged on. Velos Prime is Model 1.0 — a linear value chain. Velos Trust today operates as Model 2.0 — a platform connecting shippers, carriers, banks, and customs. But Velos's stated ambition — smart contracts that automate execution, a single source of truth across the industry, a protocol that defines how participants must operate — that is Model 3.0. The operating system of logistics. The trouble is structural: you cannot have Model 3.0 without first building Model 2.0. No ecosystem, no platform. No platform, no protocol. Velos is trying to define the rules of the system before the system itself exists.

On the current path, this trap gets worse. If Velos keeps absorbing standardization costs alone, they walk straight into the Open-Source Paradox. When standards eventually emerge industry-wide, application-layer competitors enter cheaply and capture the margins. Velos becomes the unpaid infrastructure for someone else's business model. That is the worst possible outcome — and it is exactly where the current strategy leads."

Hand-off: "[Teammate name] will walk us through the recommendation."

Slide 3 — Recommendation

Presenter B · ~4 minutes

“Our recommendation is to reject both options the board is debating. Retrench means dying slowly in a commoditizing 1.0 market — the freight market is dying anyway, just over ten years instead of two. Solo Double Down accelerates the death and hands the future to whoever benefits from the standard Velos paid to create.

The Consortium Pivot is the only move that completes the Triple Crown. Three concrete actions.

One: open the protocol. Release the core data formats as an open standard under neutral governance. This sounds counterintuitive — why give it away? Because in B2B ecosystems, proprietary lock-in is exactly what blocks adoption. Opening the protocol converts CAC into ecosystem gravity, removes the single biggest objection competitors have, and Velos retains the premium of being the reference implementation.

Two: anchor the consortium. Recruit two or three logistics competitors, one anchor bank, and one customs or regulatory body as co-founders of a governance body. This solves the chicken-and-egg problem on day one by guaranteeing minimum interaction density. It also activates Network Bridging — the strongest defense against multi-homing — by combining previously separate networks into a single value proposition no single platform can match.

Three: gate the runway. Prime cash flow does not subsidize Trust indefinitely. It funds Trust against hard 18-month milestones — consortium signatures, ARR commitments, standard ratification, and first cross-firm live transaction. If milestones miss, Trust spins out into the consortium, Velos harvests Prime, and capital is returned. That caps the downside without forcing a binary today.

The risk-adjusted picture is clear. Retrench has low risk and zero upside. Solo Double Down has high risk and a low probability of capture. The Consortium Pivot has moderate execution risk, but it is the only option that preserves optionality and aligns with how B2B disruption actually crystallizes — slow, structural, multi-party.

Elena’s framing was right: dying slowly in ten years versus running out of cash in two. The Consortium Pivot is how Velos buys a third option — anchoring the standard that will eventually disrupt the freight market, instead of being disrupted by it.

Happy to take questions.”

Q&A preparation

Presenter B fields strategy/finance questions first; Presenter A handles framework/tech.

Q. Why would competitors join a Velos-led consortium?

A. Because the alternative is each of them paying their own €15M for a proprietary standard no one adopts. Shared cost plus neutral governance is rational once one party offers it credibly. Banks and customs also need a single counterparty — they will pressure logistics firms toward consolidation.

Q. Why 18 months and not 12 or 24?

A. 12 is too short to recruit governance partners through legal review. 24 risks burning Trust's runway before milestones are testable. 18 maps to typical B2B consortium formation cycles and preserves enough Prime cash for a controlled spin-out if needed.

Q. What if no consortium members sign?

A. That is the gate. If the month-12 milestone misses, Velos initiates structured spin-out of Trust — strategic acquirer or PE — and harvests Prime. Optionality is preserved because Velos controls the timing.

Q. Doesn't this dilute Velos's competitive advantage?

A. Velos has no defensible advantage in proprietary Trust today — adoption is stalled, that is the whole problem. Opening the protocol trades a non-existent moat for two real ones: standard curator status and consortium founder leverage.

Q. Why couldn't Velos just push through to Model 3.0 directly with the consortium?

A. Model 3.0 is a destination, not a starting move. Industry protocols emerge from working ecosystems — AWS came after Amazon's e-commerce platform proved at scale; Ethereum came after Bitcoin demonstrated that distributed consensus actually works. Velos must first establish that the consortium can run cross-firm transactions reliably — that is Model 2.0. Only then does 'Velos sets the rules' carry weight. Skipping Model 2.0 is exactly what got them stuck in the first place.

Q. How do you defend against larger players (Maersk, DHL) hijacking your consortium?

A. First-mover governance leverage. Velos sets founding rules, equity splits, and IP terms. A larger entrant joins on Velos's terms or builds their own — and a second standard fragments the market against them. Velos becomes too entangled to dislodge.

Pacing target: Slide 1 ≈ 0:30 · Slide 2 ≈ 4:00 · Slide 3 ≈ 4:00 · Q&A buffer ≈ 1:30 · Total ≈ 10:00.